

Small Enterprise Management

Science

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Small Enterprise Management (A05076)

Short Title: Small Enterprise Management
Faculty Science and Computing
Department Science
Cluster Business
Author TGRANT
Credits 5

Level: Intermediate

Description of Module / Aims

To familiarise students with the key concepts and business theories relating to starting your own business within an Irish context.

Programmes

ENTR-0003 BSc in Forestry (WD_SFORS_D)

3 / 6 / M

Indicative Content

- Business entity: sole trader, partnership, limited company or co-operative
- Evaluate a new business idea: market research, interpreting research results; define what and where is the market; the importance of market conditions and trends
- Principles of marketing: product, price, distribution and promotion, unique selling point, SWOT analysis
- Financial issues relating to a small business: equity and debt, source of finance, financial records, profit and loss account, balance sheet
- Taxation: general tax issues, corporation tax, self assessment, income tax, calculating taxable profits, PAYE/PRSI; contractors tax clearance and C2 certificate
- Human resource management: CV's, job description, recruiting, interviewing techniques, employment legislation, contract of employment, managing staff

Learning Outcomes

On successful completion of this module, a student will be able to:

1. Distinguish the main types of business entity.
2. Examine a new business idea and develop a business strategy.
3. Analyse the marketing of a specific product or a range of products.
4. Determine the basic financial issues facing small businesses.
5. Determine the tax issues relating to a start-up business.
6. Examine the issues relevant to human resource management.

Learning and Teaching Methods

- Lectures.
- Class discussion on lecture content.
- Case study analysis and discussion.

Assessment Methods

	Weighing	Outcomes Assessed
Continuous Assessment	100%	
Project	30%	3,
Project	70%	1,2,4,5,6.

Assessment Criteria

- <40%:** Very limited knowledge and understanding of the subject matter. Lacking in technical ability/skill and understanding to carry out practical/professional tasks. Failure to meet the objectives of projects. Unable to carry out or submit independent study and research.
- 40%-49%:** Demonstrate a limited knowledge of the subject matter. Show some technical ability/skill in carrying out and reporting on practical/professional tasks. Attempt made to meet objectives and carry out independent study and research. Final result lacks balance and arguments undeveloped.
- 50%-59%:** Demonstrate satisfactory general knowledge of the main issues within the subject. Logically and competently carry out practical/professional tasks. Satisfactory handling and awareness in carrying out independent study and research. Reporting and projects adequately structured and referenced.
- 60%-69%:** Demonstrate sound knowledge of the subject matter. Show ability to analyse and logically argue in an effective and mature style. Demonstrate initiative and the ability to criticise methods used and appreciation of experimental design when carrying out practical/professional tasks. Projects and reporting coherent and soundly structured illustrating wide and in depth reading on subject coupled with the proper use of references.
- 70%-100%:** Demonstrate authoritative handling of complex material and a highly developed and extensive understanding of the subject. Provide well focused analysis and convincing argument on the subject. Demonstrate imaginative approach, excellent technical ability, awareness, and aptitude in carrying out and reporting on practical/professional tasks. Show initiative, individual thought, and enthusiasm in self study and independent learning.

Learning Modes

Learning Mode	F/T Hours	P/T Hours
Lecture	48	
Independent Learning	87	

Essential Material

- O'Hara, B. . _Entrepreneurship in Ireland_. 1st ed.. Ireland: Gill and Macmillan Ltd, 2011.